

## **Module 7: Getting the Project Approved**

### **Topic: What is the your Situation?**

Before starting, assess your current situation by asking the following:

Key Questions:

1. Assigned Responsibility

Are you responsible for implementing a management system and guiding it through the certification audit within your organization?

2. Initiating a Project

Do you believe the implementation of a management system and its certification would benefit your organization, and are you aiming to initiate a project with top management?

3. Consulting Opportunities

Are you a consultant wanting to engage with top management in organizations considering the implementation and certification of a management system?

What to Do Based on Your Situation:

- If Situation 1 (Responsible for Implementation)

Skip this module and proceed to the next module: Prepare for Implementation.

- If Situation 2 (Looking to Initiate the Project)

Skip the next unit and proceed to How to Get the Interest of Top Management in the Project.

- If You Are a Consultant

Continue with the next unit of this module.

### **For Consultants: Getting More Sales Meetings with Prospects**

To improve your chances of closing deals, you need to increase the number of sales meetings with potential clients. Here's how:

Key Steps:

1. Prepare Your Prospects Before Reaching Out

- a. Don't contact prospects cold. First, make sure they know who you are and what you do.

2. Organized Prospecting Campaign
  - b. Identify target customers and develop strategies to introduce yourself and your services.
  - c. Methods include:
  - d. Emails, newsletters, blogs
  - e. Publishing articles in technical magazines or professional networks.
3. Establish Yourself as an Expert
  - a. Speak at events with large audiences (50-100 potential customers).
  - b. Nurture your network by building connections and getting introductions from others.
4. Leverage Written Content
  - a. Share your knowledge and experience.
  - b. Showcase testimonials from satisfied clients to build credibility.
  - c. Use platforms like blogs, professional networks, and trade magazines to distribute your content.

### **How to Get Top Management's Interest in Your Project**

To convince top management of the benefits of implementing and certifying a management system, you need to speak their language: profit, market share, cost-cutting, client satisfaction, and business strategy. Here are key points to present:

Key Benefits to Highlight:

1. Meet Customer Requirements
  - a. Does the company have customers who require management system certification?
  - b. Estimate potential lost business due to lack of certification and the possible additional revenue from new or current customers.
2. Cut Business Maintenance Costs
  - a. If the company undergoes multiple audits from clients, estimate the cost of those versus one certification audit.
  - b. Highlight savings from fewer audits.
3. Improve Customer Satisfaction
  - a. Assess the level of customer complaints and potential lost business due to poor satisfaction.

4. Better Process Integration
  - a. Identify areas where processes are not integrated well, leading to consistent complaints between departments.
  - b. Estimate the cost savings from improved integration, possibly revealed through ISO 9001.
5. Improved Decision-Making
  - a. Provide examples where better data availability could have improved decision outcomes (e.g., delays, cost overruns).
6. Create a Culture of Continual Improvement
  - a. Show how integrating processes can lead to continuous improvement within the organization.
7. Employee Engagement and Retention
  - a. If high turnover is an issue, emphasize potential cost savings from keeping employees engaged, thus reducing training and onboarding costs.

By aligning the benefits of the management system with top management's priorities, you increase the likelihood of getting their buy-in.

### **How to Present the Project as a Consultant**

When meeting with a prospect for the first time, it's essential to focus on their needs and how you can address them. Here's how to structure your presentation:

Key Steps:

1. Introduce Yourself and Your Contributions
  - a. Start with your name, your experience, and what you can offer.
  - b. Explain how you can help and the outcomes they can expect from working with you.
2. Do Your Homework
  - a. Research the organization, their industry, clients, and challenges.
  - b. Tailor your presentation to show how your project can support their progress and goals.
3. Focus on What They Will Get

- a. Frame your presentation around the benefits for the prospect, not just what you do.
- 4. Understand Their Situation
  - a. Before the meeting, ask why they need help now and why they contacted you.
  - b. Know what specific challenges or goals they need to address.
- 5. Ask the Right Questions During the Meeting
  - a. What do they want to achieve?
  - b. How will they measure success?
  - c. When do they want to start, and what resources will they allocate?
- 6. Follow-Up After the Meeting
  - a. Send a thank-you email summarizing the discussion.
  - b. Include any necessary follow-up, such as a proposal or next steps.

### **Other Techniques for Presenting the Project Effectively**

To present your project more effectively, consider the following techniques:

Key Techniques:

- 1. Elevator Speech
  - a. Prepare a 30-60 second speech for informal situations (e.g., meeting a CEO in a cafeteria or elevator).
  - b. Rehearse it to sound confident and convincing, focusing on the key benefits of your project.
- 2. Find an Ally
  - a. Look for individuals close to top management, like the Chief Financial Officer or others interested in your project.
  - b. These allies can provide additional insights into how the management system benefits the company and help you get on the CEO's agenda faster.

If you're an insider working within the company, skip the next unit and move on to the next module: Prepare for Implementation.

### **For Consultants: Writing a Great Proposal**

When writing a proposal, focus on the client's desired outcomes and how your project will benefit their business.

Key Points:

1. Focus on Outcomes, Not Yourself
  - a. Clearly state what the client will gain and how it will benefit their business.
2. Clarify Conditions
  - a. List the resources the organization must provide and any constraints.
  - b. Define what you will deliver and what you expect from the company to ensure smooth project progress.
3. Include Project Duration and Milestones
  - a. Specify the timeline, key milestones, and project duration.
4. State Pricing and Payment Terms
  - a. Detail the price, payment schedule, and terms (invoicing, taxes, expenses, travel, etc.).
5. Keep It Short
  - a. A concise proposal is more effective and focused on the client.
6. Follow-Up
  - a. After submitting the proposal, schedule a follow-up to show interest, but avoid being overly pushy.